AIDCF

AI Data Centre Facilities Assurance Framework

ASSURANCE PROGRAM FRAMEWORK

Version 1.1

A non-certification programme standard for commissioning, governing, delivering, reviewing, sustaining and improving AIDCF assurance

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AIDCF defines the method. Users and assurance providers apply it. Accountable organisations own risks and decisions. This framework issues no certificate.

Document control

Field	Value
Title	AIDCF-011 Assurance Program Framework
Artifact ID	AIDCF-011 (requirement short code APF)
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Author	Siva Sethumadhavan
Depends on	AIDCF-006, AIDCF-007A, AIDCF-008, AIDCF-009 (Part A and Part B), AIDCF-010, AIDCF-012, AIDCF-014
Purpose	Define repeatable AIDCF assurance programmes without establishing AIDCF as a certification or accreditation body.
Users	Organisations, customers, assurance providers, internal audit, investors and regulators using AIDCF for bounded decisions.
Inputs	Controls, evidence, workpapers, Gate Results, scores, Findings, scenarios and decisions.
Outputs	Charter, plan, assessment package, bounded statement (AIDCF-012), action plan, reassessment, continuing-assurance and management-review records.
Non-certification	No AIDCF certificate, certification mark, accredited status or universal claim is created.
Safety	No programme authorises hazardous testing or replaces licensed professional judgment.

Revision history

Version	Date	Summary
1.0	—	Initial programme framework (published under the superseded identifier AIDCF-APF-001).

Version	Date	Summary
1.1	2026-10-10	Confirmed AL0–AL6 as the canonical Assurance Levels with claim-type mapping; removed duplicate statement templates in favour of AIDCF-012 AS-01–AS-05; made this document the single home of reviewer and release-gate tables; added the management-system loop (PDCA, programme internal audit, management review, corrective action, continual improvement) with ISO/IEC 42001 and ISO/IEC 27001 integration; consolidated boilerplate profiles and playbooks; aligned vocabularies and graph mappings; introduced APF-REQ requirement IDs with mapping annex.

Executive thesis

AIDCF-011 converts the AIDCF method into a usable, self-improving assurance programme while preserving the separation between framework ownership, assessment delivery, evidence review, management accountability and any separately regulated certification activity.

0 Introduction

0.1 Normative language

"Shall" and "shall not" state requirements; "should" and "should not" state recommendations; "may" states a permission; "can" states a capability (ISO/IEC Directives, Part 2 usage). Requirements carry identifiers APF-REQ-NNN.

0.2 Relationship to other AIDCF artifacts

Artifact	Relationship
AIDCF-009	Part A defines how each assessment in a programme is performed; Part B provides execution aids. AIDCF-011 governs the programme in which assessments run.
AIDCF-010	Defines gate criteria, scoring, decision ceilings and decision-state rules applied in every programme evaluation.
AIDCF-012	Defines report classes, assurance statement templates AS-01–AS-05 and the authoritative controlled decision wording.
AIDCF-008	Defines evidence semantics, floors and confidence used by every programme.

Part I — Authority and boundaries

AIDCF-011 standardises programmes, not certification.

Element	Programme rule
Framework owner	Maintains methodology, schemas and change control.
Programme sponsor	Defines and authorises the decision need.
Assessed organisation	Owns capability, evidence access, risks and actions.

Element	Programme rule
Assurance provider	Performs work under its own professional and contractual authority.
Decision authority	Issues the bounded Assurance Decision or records that none is issued.
Permitted wording	"Assessed using AIDCF"; "AIDCF-aligned assessment"; "provider-issued AIDCF-aligned assurance statement".
Prohibited wording	"AIDCF Certified"; "AIDCF Accredited"; any universal safe, secure or resilient claim.
Separate certification	Any certification scheme is outside this framework and remains the responsibility of a separately governed body.

APF-REQ-001 No programme, provider or assessed organisation shall describe an AIDCF programme output as a certificate, accreditation, certification mark or endorsement by the framework owner.

Part II — Programme principles

Programmes retain the AIDCF constitutional invariants (AIDCF-006).

Element	Programme rule
Capability first	A defined Capability Instance and Service Outcomes.
Evidence gated	Every material claim has evidence or an explicit UNKNOWN Record.
UNKNOWN visible	Missing, stale, inaccessible and conflicting evidence remains non-favourable.
Gate dominance	Critical gates cannot be averaged away.
Claim distinction	DESIGN, IMPLEMENTATION, OPERATION, EFFECTIVENESS and RESILIENCE claims remain distinct.
Boundary visibility	External and excluded dependencies remain visible.
Safety	Collection and testing are authorised and proportionate.
Competence	Collective technical and assurance competence.
Bounded conclusion	Scope, operating states, time, evidence and limitations stated.
Reassessment	Material change can suspend prior reliance.
Improvement	The programme itself is planned, checked and improved as a management system (Part XXI).

Part III — Programme models

Model	Programme rule	AIDCF-012 statement template
First-party	Organisation self-assessment for readiness and improvement.	AS-01
Co-sourced	Management and provider share work with an explicit responsibility split.	AS-02
Second-party	Customer, investor or contracting party assesses a provider for a decision.	AS-03
Independent third-party	Provider performs the work and issues its own bounded statement.	AS-04
Regulatory support	Structures evidence and analysis; does not determine legal compliance unless separately authorised.	AS-01–AS-04 per model, with R7 package

Model	Programme rule	AIDCF-012 statement template
Diligence	Bounded review for transaction, finance, capacity or outsourcing.	AS-03 or AS-04
Internal audit	May use AIDCF under its existing charter and professional standards.	AS-01 (internal) or AS-04 where independence is established
Continuing assurance	Claim-specific evidence refresh and event-driven reassessment, not universal continuous assurance.	AS-05

APF-REQ-002 Every programme shall declare its model in the programme charter and shall use the AIDCF-012 statement template that corresponds to that model.

Part IV — Assurance Levels (canonical)

Assurance Levels describe programme depth, not certification grades. AL0–AL6 are the canonical AIDCF Assurance Levels; other artifacts refer to them and do not redefine them.

Level	Name	Purpose	Claim types that may be concluded	Typical evidence profile tier (AIDCF-008)	Assurance Decision
AL0	Discovery	Inventory of capability, controls, evidence and decision need.	None	—	No Assurance Decision is issued; discovery report only.
AL1	Readiness	Scope, ownership, applicability and evidence readiness.	None (readiness Findings only)	CP-1	No Assurance Decision on Service Outcomes; readiness conclusion reported without a decision state.
AL2	Design	Requirements, architecture and safeguard design.	DESIGN	CP-1, CP-2	Decision states apply to design adequacy only.
AL3	Implementation	Reconciliation to implemented or as-built state.	DESIGN, IMPLEMENTATION	CP-2	Decision states apply to design and implementation claims.
AL4	Operational	Representative operation, monitoring, maintenance and incidents over a declared period.	DESIGN, IMPLEMENTATION, OPERATION	CP-3	Decision states apply up to operation over the declared period.
AL5	Effectiveness and resilience	Safeguard effectiveness, failure containment and recovery.	All five claim types	CP-4, CP-5	Decision states apply to all claims within tested and observed conditions.
AL6	Continuing	Refresh of approved claims, evidence, gates and triggers.	The claim types previously concluded, for designated claims	As for the original level	Continuing update (AIDCF-012 AS-05) of an existing decision; lifecycle may move to SUSPENDED, WITHDRAWN or SUPERSEDED.

Each control in the AIDCF-007A registry has a "Required Assurance Level" (AL2–AL5) equal to the minimum level for its claim type (DESIGN AL2, IMPLEMENTATION AL3, OPERATION AL4, EFFECTIVENESS AL5, RESILIENCE AL5). Legacy registry values A2–A5 map one-to-one to AL2–AL5.

APF-REQ-003 A programme statement shall not conclude on any claim type above those permitted for the programme's Assurance Level in Part IV.

APF-REQ-004 Programmes and reports shall express programme depth only as AL0–AL6 as defined in Part IV.

Part V — Assessment types

Type	Programme rule	Typical level
Baseline	Initial capability-wide understanding.	AL0–AL1
Readiness	Preparation for deployment or deeper assurance.	AL1
Design	Pre-build or architecture decision support.	AL2
Implementation	As-built, commissioning or handover.	AL3
Operational	Current operating effectiveness over a declared period.	AL4
Resilience	Failure, degraded state, containment and recovery.	AL5
Major change	Delta assessment after material change.	Level of the affected claims
Incident triggered	Impact on prior claims and residual state.	Level of the affected claims
Periodic	Planned reassessment of defined claims and gates.	Level of the original decision
Continuing	Evidence and trigger monitoring for approved assertions.	AL6

Part VI — Programme lifecycle

The programme lifecycle governs AIDCF-009 execution and maps onto the Plan-Do-Check-Act cycle of Part XXI.

Stage	Programme rule	PDCA	AIDCF-009 stage gate
P0 Need	Business decision, intended users and authority.	Plan	SG0
P1 Charter	Decision question, capability, outcomes and programme model.	Plan	SG0
P2 Scope/profile	Boundary, level, controls, states, gates and exclusions.	Plan	SG1
P3 Provider	Competence, independence, conflicts and rules of engagement.	Plan	SG2
P4 Plan	Evidence, methods, samples, tests, safety and reviews.	Plan	SG2
P5 Execute	AIDCF-009 fieldwork and workpapers.	Do	SG3
P6 Evaluate	Findings, scenarios, Gate Results, UNKNOWN, scores and recommendation.	Do	SG4
P7 Review	Technical and independent challenge.	Check	SG5
P8 Decide/report	Accountable decision and bounded statement.	Do	SG6
P9 Improve/sustain	Actions, closure evidence, validity, monitoring, reassessment and programme improvement.	Check, Act	SG7

Part VII — Governance roles

Role	Programme rule
Steering group	Approves charter, scope, changes and unresolved conflicts; performs management review (Part XXI).
Capability owner	Owns outcomes, risks and actions.
Programme lead	Coordinates programme design, delivery and improvement.
Lead assessor	Directs assessment and integration.
Domain specialists	Approve technical methods and conclusions.
Evidence lead	Controls requirements, provenance and disclosure.
Independent reviewer	Challenges method, evidence, gates and wording.
Decision authority	Issues the Assurance Decision or records that none is issued.
Action owners	Deliver remediation and closure evidence.
Programme auditor	Performs internal audit of the assurance programme (Part XXI); independent of the programme lead.
Tool owner	Implements workflows without hidden authority.

Part VIII — Independence

Programme model / situation	Programme rule
Self-assessment	Management review plus independent challenge for material gates.
Co-sourced	Separate preparation, testing, evaluation and review.
Second-party	Disclose commissioner, purpose and access constraints.
Independent provider	Apply provider conflict, quality and liability rules.
Prior advisory work	Address self-review threat or restrict scope.
Outcome-contingent fees	Prohibited for assurance conclusions.
Management decisions	Assessors do not accept risk or operate controls for management.
Specialist reliance	Record competence, scope and responsibility.

APF-REQ-005 Fees or other rewards for an assurance provider shall not be contingent on the decision state issued.

APF-REQ-006 A person who designed, operated or advised on a subject within the previous assessment period shall not assess or independently review that subject unless the self-review threat is safeguarded and the safeguard is disclosed in the statement.

Part IX — Competence

AIDCF states competence expectations but does not accredit people or firms. AIDCF-009 Part B Part VII provides competence levels AC-0 to AC-6 that programmes may adopt.

Discipline	Competence expectation
Programme lead	Programme governance, intended use, stakeholders and improvement.

Discipline	Competence expectation
Lead assessor	AIDCF method, assurance, evidence, gates and decisions.
Electrical	Power architecture, protection, power quality and testing.
Mechanical	Cooling, thermal, fluid and recovery.
Compute	AI/HPC architecture, firmware and recovery.
Storage/network	Integrity, performance, fabrics, failover and restore.
Operations/resilience	Reliability, incident, continuity and crisis.
OT/security	Identity, authority, control plane and response.
Evidence/data	Provenance, integrity, analytics, privacy and custody.
Independent reviewer	Senior assurance competence and impartial challenge.
Programme auditor	Management-system audit competence and knowledge of AIDCF.

Part X — Scoping

Ambiguous boundaries cannot support strong reliance.

Element	Programme rule
Capability	Identity, owner, lifecycle and architecture baseline.
Service outcomes	Function, tolerance, duration, operating state and consequence.
Boundary	Physical, logical, organisational, provider and temporal.
Operating states	Declared from NORMAL, DEGRADED, MAINTENANCE, EMERGENCY, RECOVERY, TRANSITION, SHUTDOWN, FAILED (AIDCF-003 §45).
Controls	Applicable AIDCF-007A controls and assigned claim types.
Gates	Applicable CG-01 to CG-15 and evidence floors.
Dependencies	Internal, external, shared, common-mode and recovery.
Exclusions	Visible rationale and residual effect.
Intended users	Named users and permitted reliance.
Materiality	Decision-specific, using the AIDCF definition of material.

Part XI — Evidence and testing

Programmes apply AIDCF-008 and AIDCF-009 without changing source authority.

Element	Programme rule
Evidence plan	Assertion-specific classes, quality, sufficiency and timing.
Intake	Identity, source, collector, custodian, classification and integrity.
Conflict	Retain supporting, challenging and qualifying evidence.
Derived evidence	Source lineage, transformation, assumptions and review.
Sampling	Population, strata, method, expansion and limitation.

Element	Programme rule
Testing	Authority, initial state, method, abort and restoration.
Safety	The safety authority can stop work.
Restricted evidence	Alternative evidence or explicit UNKNOWN Record.
Retention	Legal, contractual, audit and decision lineage.
Disclosure	Minimum necessary information with protection and redaction.

Part XII — Evaluation

AIDCF-010 supports synthesis while the decision authority retains the decision.

Element	Programme rule
Control results	CONFORMING, PARTIAL, NONCONFORMING, UNKNOWN, NOT_APPLICABLE, NOT_ASSESSED, recorded per control and claim type.
Findings	Condition, criterion, evidence, cause and consequence.
Scenarios	Propagation, safeguards, residual state and recovery.
Gates	PASS, FAIL, UNKNOWN, APPROVED_NA or NOT_ASSESSED by the AIDCF-009 roll-up rule; no conditional gate result.
UNKNOWN	Type U1–U10, severity US1–US5 and decision effect.
Scores	Control, family and domain scores with coverage and band, or "Band withheld (coverage/UNKNOWN)" (AIDCF-010). Scores never override gates.
Recommendation	Controlling reasons and prohibited higher states.
Review	Technical and independent challenge.
Decision	REASONABLY_ASSURED, CONDITIONALLY_ASSURED, LIMITED, NOT_ASSURED or INCONCLUSIVE, derived in the AIDCF-010 order (gates → UNKNOWN severity → coverage → bands → conditions and confidence) and worded per AIDCF-012 Part V.
Conditions	Named, owned, time-bound and evidence-based.

APF-REQ-007 Every programme decision shall be expressed in the controlled decision wording of AIDCF-012 Part V, which is the single authoritative wording table for AIDCF decision states.

Part XIII — Assurance statement

The programme output is a bounded statement, not a certificate. Statement content and templates are defined in AIDCF-012 (templates AS-01 to AS-05 and lifecycle notices AS-06 to AS-08); this framework does not define separate templates. The programme determines which template applies (Part III) and who may issue it:

Programme responsibility	Rule
Issuer	The organisation or provider issuing under its own authority, named in the charter.
Users and use	Named audience and decision, as chartered.
Template	AS-01 first-party; AS-02 co-sourced; AS-03 second-party; AS-04 independent provider; AS-05 continuing update.

Programme responsibility	Rule
Authorisation	Decision authority after independent review (AIDCF-009 SG5, SG6; PG-7, PG-8).
Non-certification	Every statement carries the AIDCF-012 non-certification note.

APF-REQ-008 Assurance statements issued within a programme shall use the AIDCF-012 template for the programme model and shall not be issued before the independent review and decision-authority approval have been recorded.

Part XIV — Prohibited claims

Claim	Programme rule
AIDCF Certified	Prohibited.
AIDCF Accredited	Prohibited.
Compliant with all laws	Prohibited unless separately authorised and evidenced.
Safe/secure/resilient universally	Prohibited guarantee.
Continuous assurance universally	Prohibited unless specific monitored claims and blind spots are defined.
Pass based on score	Prohibited when gates or UNKNOWN control.
Engineering approval	AIDCF does not replace it.
Framework-owner endorsement	Not implied by use.
Public ranking	Requires a separate approved cohort method.
Transfer of assurance	Requires applicability across capability, boundary, state and time.

Part XV — Reporting

Different reports use the same underlying evidence and decision. Report classes are defined in AIDCF-012 Part III.

Programme need	AIDCF-012 report class
Executive reporting	R1 Executive Assurance Report
Technical record	R2 Technical Assessment Report; R3 Domain Report
Evidence	R4 Evidence Package
Gates and decision	R5 Gate and Decision Package
Relying party	R6 Customer/Second-Party Statement
Regulator	R7 Regulatory Support Package
Public	R8 Public Summary (never stronger than the full report)
Continuing	R9 Continuing-Assurance Report
Remediation	R10 Remediation/Closure Report

Management responses remain separate from assessor conclusions (AIDCF-012 Part XI).

Part XVI — Validity and reassessment

No conclusion remains valid indefinitely by default.

Element	Programme rule
Validity	Point in time or period, conditions and evidence basis; lifecycle EXPIRED at end of validity.
Evidence expiry	Mandatory evidence expiry triggers review.
Material change	Architecture, capacity, configuration, supplier or ownership.
Incident	May set affected decisions to SUSPENDED.
Gate change	A Gate Result change to FAIL or UNKNOWN, or a new US4/US5 UNKNOWN, triggers review.
Closure	Requires evidence and reassessment.
Periodic review	Set by risk, freshness and reliance.
Supersession	New decision SUPERSEDES the prior; history preserved.
Withdrawal	Issuer sets WITHDRAWN when reliance is no longer defensible.

APF-REQ-009 Every ACTIVE Assurance Decision issued within a programme shall have a stated validity end date or triggering event after which its lifecycle state becomes EXPIRED unless reassessed.

Part XVII — Continuing assurance

Continuing assurance (AL6) is claim-specific monitoring plus human decision.

Element	Programme rule
Baseline	Initial defensible assessment and ACTIVE decision.
Source register	Authoritative sources, owners and health.
Monitored claims	Explicit propositions, operating states and dependencies.
Refresh	Evidence validation cadence.
Triggers	Change, incident, threshold, missing data, conflict and gate event.
Blind spots	Source outage and uncovered states visible.
Human review	Automation proposes; the decision authority approves material status.
Decision effect	Maintain ACTIVE, add or change conditions (new decision), SUSPENDED, WITHDRAWN, or reassess.
Snapshot	Immutable evidence, rules and lineage.

APF-REQ-010 Continuing assurance shall be limited to explicitly designated claims with defined sources, refresh cadence, triggers and blind spots, and shall not be described as continuous assurance of the whole Capability Instance.

Part XVIII — Quality and challenge

Element	Programme rule
Quality plan	Review points and technical approvals.

Element	Programme rule
Hot review	Before material conclusion.
Cold review	Post-issuance sample.
Consultation	Resolve specialist disagreement.
Evidence challenge	Assertion-to-evidence trace and contrary evidence.
Appeal	Challenge facts or method, not negotiate outcome.
Complaint	Conduct, confidentiality and process concerns.
Correction	Material error triggers corrected or superseding report.
Conflict register	Commercial, management and reviewer conflicts.

APF-REQ-011 The programme shall perform cold reviews of a sample of issued decisions in each management-review period and shall feed the results into corrective action (Part XXI).

Part XIX — Data and graph

Assurance does not justify overcollection or exposure of infrastructure paths.

Element	Programme rule
Minimisation	Collect only for precise assertions.
Authorisation	Source-owner approval.
Classification	Protect architecture, credentials, controls and dependencies.
Segregation	Separate client, provider and public packages.
Redaction	Preserve limitations when details are withheld from disclosure.
Retention/deletion	Preserve obligations and lineage.
Graph security	Restrict sensitive paths and exports.
AI use	AI-derived material is candidate, lineage-linked and reviewed.
Native conclusions	AIDCF and AITG decisions remain separate.

Part XX — Commercial deployment

AIDCF supports services and products without certification claims.

Offering	Programme rule
Readiness review	Profile, evidence gaps and roadmap.
Design assurance	Architecture and safeguard design.
Deployment assurance	Implementation, commissioning and handover.
Operational assurance	Representative operating evidence and gates.
Resilience assurance	Scenario, containment, recovery and exercise.
Continuing assurance	Subscription or cadence for approved monitored claims.
Second-party review	Supplier or customer decision support.

Offering	Programme rule
Platform subscription	Workflow, evidence and graph; human authority remains.
Benchmarking	Comparable cohort analytics.
Method licence	Use under terms; no implied endorsement.

Part XXI — Management-system integration and continual improvement

An AIDCF assurance programme is operated as a management system: it is planned, performed, checked and improved, and it can be integrated with an organisation's existing management systems. In particular, it is designed to sit within or alongside an AI management system conforming to ISO/IEC 42001 and an information security management system conforming to ISO/IEC 27001. Both standards follow the ISO harmonized structure for management system standards; AIDCF does not reproduce their requirements and conformance to AIDCF-011 does not imply conformance to either standard.

XXI.1 Plan-Do-Check-Act loop

PDCA phase	AIDCF programme activity	Records
Plan	Establish programme scope, objectives (for example coverage of critical Capability Instances, timeliness of reassessment), risks to the programme, resources, competence and the programme plan (P0–P4).	Programme charter, profile, plan, objectives
Do	Execute assessments under AIDCF-009, evaluate under AIDCF-010, decide and report under AIDCF-012 (P5–P8).	Assessment packages, decisions, statements
Check	Monitor programme performance indicators; perform internal audit of the assurance programme; perform cold reviews; hold management review.	Indicator reports, audit reports, review minutes
Act	Address nonconformities with corrective action; implement improvements to method application, competence, tooling and evidence architecture.	Corrective-action and improvement registers

XXI.2 Programme objectives and performance indicators

The programme sets measurable objectives and monitors them. Indicators are programme parameters chosen by the steering group; examples: proportion of in-scope Capability Instances with an ACTIVE decision; proportion of decisions reassessed before EXPIRED; number and age of open US4/US5 UNKNOWN Records; proportion of conditions closed by their due date; cold-review exceptions; corrective actions overdue.

APF-REQ-012 The programme shall define measurable objectives and performance indicators, review them at each management review and record the action taken where an objective is not met.

XXI.3 Internal audit of the assurance programme

Internal audit of the programme examines whether the programme conforms to AIDCF-011 and to the organisation's own programme requirements, and whether it is effectively implemented. It is distinct from AIDCF assessments of Capability Instances: it audits how assurance is done, not the infrastructure.

Audit topic	Examples of audit evidence
Method conformance	Sampled assessment packages traced against AIDCF-009 Part A requirements and stage gates.
Independence and competence	Conflict declarations, AC-level records, reviewer separation.
Evidence integrity	Evidence manifests, custody and integrity references.
Decision integrity	Decision states versus Gate Results, UNKNOWN severities and AIDCF-010 ceilings; controlled wording per AIDCF-012.
Validity and reassessment	Triggers fired versus reassessments performed; expired decisions still relied on.
Prohibited claims	Published material checked against Part XIV.

APF-REQ-013 The programme shall be internally audited at planned intervals, set by the steering group in proportion to reliance, by an auditor independent of the programme lead and of the assessments sampled; audit results shall be reported to management review.

XXI.4 Management review

Inputs	Outputs
Status of actions from previous reviews; changes in context (new AI infrastructure, providers, regulation, AIDCF artifact versions); performance indicators; internal-audit and cold-review results; nonconformities and corrective actions; appeals and complaints; open US4/US5 UNKNOWN Records across the portfolio; resource and competence adequacy; interfaces with ISO/IEC 42001 and ISO/IEC 27001 management reviews.	Decisions on improvement, resources, programme scope and objectives; changes to the programme plan; escalation of portfolio-level risks to the organisation's governance.

APF-REQ-014 The steering group shall conduct a management review of the programme at planned intervals, using at least the inputs listed in XXI.4, and shall record its decisions and actions.

XXI.5 Nonconformity and corrective action

A programme nonconformity is a failure of the programme to meet AIDCF-011, AIDCF-009 or its own requirements (for example a decision issued without independent review, a decision above its gate ceiling, a reassessment trigger not acted on). It is distinct from a Finding about the assessed infrastructure.

APF-REQ-015 For each programme nonconformity the programme shall correct it, evaluate whether issued decisions are affected (and, where they are, correct, suspend or supersede them under AIDCF-012), determine its cause, implement corrective action to prevent recurrence and review the effectiveness of that action.

XXI.6 Continual improvement

Improvement sources include corrective actions, audit and cold-review results, assessor feedback on AIDCF-009 procedures, recurring UNKNOWN causes (for example systematic evidence-access limits) and changes to the AIDCF artifacts. Proposed changes to AIDCF artifacts are submitted to the framework owner's change control.

APF-REQ-016 The programme shall maintain an improvement register and shall record, for each improvement, its source, owner, status and effect on programme objectives.

XXI.7 Integration with ISO/IEC 42001 and ISO/IEC 27001 management systems

Management-system topic (harmonized structure)	AIDCF programme contribution	Integration note
Context of the organisation	Capability Instances, Service Outcomes, dependency and boundary records (AIDCF-009 B2, B3).	AI infrastructure dependencies inform the AI management system's context and the ISMS scope.
Leadership	Steering group, decision authority and accountability (Part VII; CG-13).	Align decision authorities with roles assigned in the existing management systems.
Planning (risks, opportunities, objectives)	Programme objectives (XXI.2); gate-based risk view (CG-01–CG-15); UNKNOWN portfolio.	AIDCF Findings and UNKNOWN Records can be inputs to AI-system and information-security risk assessment and treatment.
Support (resources, competence, documented information)	Competence (Part IX; AC levels), evidence architecture (AIDCF-008), records retention.	Reuse existing document-control and competence processes where they meet AIDCF-008 provenance and custody requirements.
Operation	Assessments under AIDCF-009, change control (CG-14), digital authority (CG-15).	ISMS operational controls for identity, access and supplier security provide evidence for SEC and SUP controls.
Performance evaluation	Indicators, internal audit of the programme, management review (XXI.2–XXI.4).	Programme internal audit and management review may be combined with those of the existing systems if AIDCF inputs are covered explicitly.
Improvement	Nonconformity, corrective action and improvement register (XXI.5–XXI.6).	Use a common corrective-action process with AIDCF-specific classification of programme nonconformities.

APF-REQ-017 Where the organisation operates an ISO/IEC 42001 or ISO/IEC 27001 management system, the programme charter shall state how programme planning, internal audit, management review and corrective action are integrated with or kept separate from that system, and evidence drawn from it shall still meet AIDCF-008 requirements.

Part XXII — Review and release gates (single authoritative table)

This table is the single authoritative list of reviewer roles and release-gate states for AIDCF-009 (Part A and Part B), AIDCF-011 and AIDCF-012. Those documents refer to it and do not maintain their own tables.

Reviewer role / pilot	Applies to	Review focus	Status
Methodology author	009A, 009B, 011, 012	Coherence with AIDCF-006 invariants and the canonical vocabularies.	Pending
Lead assessor peer	009A, 009B	Practical execution of procedures, decision trees and templates.	Pending
Assurance and reporting specialist	011, 012	Programme models, statements and controlled decision wording.	Pending
Electrical engineering reviewer	009A, 009B	Power playbook, inspection points, CG-05 and CG-04 workbooks.	Pending
Mechanical engineering reviewer	009A, 009B	Thermal playbook, inspection points, CG-06 workbook.	Pending

Reviewer role / pilot	Applies to	Review focus	Status
Compute / HPC reviewer	009A, 009B, 012	Compute procedures, CG-08 workbook, technical reporting.	Pending
Storage and network reviewer	009A, 009B	Storage and network procedures, CG-08 and CG-10 workbooks.	Pending
Operations and reliability reviewer	009A, 009B	Fieldwork, operations and recovery procedures.	Pending
OT and security reviewer	009A, 009B, 011	Control-plane procedures, CG-07 and CG-15 workbooks, graph security.	Pending
Evidence specialist	009A, 009B, 012	Alignment with AIDCF-008; evidence playbooks and evidence reporting.	Pending
Safety, legal and privacy reviewer	009A, 009B, 011, 012	Testing boundaries, disclosure, classification and liability.	Pending
Independent provider reviewer	011, 012	Independence safeguards and statement usability.	Pending
Internal audit reviewer	011	Programme internal audit and management-system integration.	Pending
Second-party / customer reviewer	011, 012	Relying-party needs and AS-03 statement.	Pending
Regulatory liaison	012	R7 package.	Pending
Board reader	012	R1 executive report comprehension.	Pending
Accessibility and design reviewer	012	Part XIV visual and accessibility rules.	Pending
Ontology, schema and AITG reviewer	009B, 011, 012	Graph mappings and machine-readable packages against AIDCF-014.	Pending
Practitioner pilot (assessment)	009A, 009B	Reproducibility of results by an independent practitioner on a synthetic dataset.	Pending
Programme pilots (first-party, co-sourced, third-party, continuing)	011	Programme operation across models.	Pending
Reporting pilots (executive, technical, statement, dashboard)	012	Report classes and templates.	Pending
Public release	009A, 009B, 011, 012	All gates above.	Not approved

APF-REQ-018 AIDCF-009, AIDCF-011 and AIDCF-012 shall not be released for public use until every reviewer role applicable to the document in Part XXII has recorded its review and the public-release gate has been passed through the framework owner's change control.

Programme stage gates

Advance only when exit criteria are met; limitations remain explicit as UNKNOWN Records rather than as conditional approvals. A programme stage gate has the outcomes PROCEED, RETURN or STOP.

Gate	Exit criteria	AIDCF-009 stage gate
PG-0 Authorise	Need, sponsor, users and authority.	SG0
PG-1 Charter	Question, capability, outcomes and model.	SG0
PG-2 Scope	Boundary, profile, level, gates and exclusions.	SG1
PG-3 Provider	Competence, independence and rules.	SG2

Gate	Exit criteria	AIDCF-009 stage gate
PG-4 Plan	Evidence, methods, safety and reviews.	SG2
PG-5 Complete	Fieldwork complete or UNKNOWN visible.	SG3
PG-6 Technical review	Domain conclusions and Gate Results approved.	SG4
PG-7 Independent review	Package and wording challenged.	SG5
PG-8 Issue	Decision and statement authorised.	SG6
PG-9 Sustain	Actions, evidence custody and triggers active; programme indicators updated.	SG7

Domain programme coverage

Programme coverage applies the same rules in every domain: decisions link to the Capability Instance and Service Outcomes; scope covers assets, functions, providers, interfaces, operating states and dependencies; depth is set by AL0–AL6; methods are those of AIDCF-009; evidence follows AIDCF-008; outputs are results, Findings, UNKNOWN Records, Gate Results and a domain conclusion; material conclusions receive competent specialist and independent review; reassessment follows architecture, capacity, provider, incident and evidence triggers. The domain-specific elements are:

Domain	Programme coverage focus	Principal gates informed (see AIDCF-007A registry v1.1 for control-level mappings)	Domain guide
GOV	Authority, decisions, policy and impartiality.	CG-13, CG-14	AIDCF-018-GOV
CAP	Capability, outcomes, demand and envelope.	CG-01, CG-02	AIDCF-018-CAP
DEP	Dependencies, concentration, providers and boundary.	CG-03, CG-02, CG-09	AIDCF-018-DEP
PHY	Site, structure, zoning, access, custody and life safety.	CG-04, CG-02	AIDCF-018-PHY
POW	Supply, generation, storage, distribution, quality and recovery.	CG-05, CG-04, CG-07, CG-10	AIDCF-018-POW
THM	Air and liquid cooling, heat rejection, fluids and thermal recovery.	CG-06, CG-04, CG-07, CG-10	AIDCF-018-THM
ENV	Environmental conditions, energy, water, carbon, hazards and climate.	CG-04, CG-02	AIDCF-018-ENV
CMP	Accelerator architecture, capacity, firmware, health and recovery.	CG-08, CG-09, CG-10	AIDCF-018-CMP
STO	Tiers, performance, integrity, protection and checkpoint recovery.	CG-08, CG-10	AIDCF-018-STO
NET	Fabrics, congestion, service and management networks, optics, control.	CG-08, CG-09, CG-10	AIDCF-018-NET
OPS	Staffing, work control, maintenance, alarms, change and capacity.	CG-07, CG-13, CG-14	AIDCF-018-OPS
RES	Strategy, containment, continuity, recovery, exercising and crisis.	CG-09, CG-10	AIDCF-018-RES

Domain	Programme coverage focus	Principal gates informed (see AIDCF-007A registry v1.1 for control-level mappings)	Domain guide
SUP	Suppliers, contracts, provenance, updates, spares and remote support.	CG-03, CG-13, CG-15	AIDCF-018-SUP
SEC	Identity, control planes, segmentation, patching, detection, automation.	CG-07, CG-15	AIDCF-018-SEC
EVA	Evidence, execution, Findings, gates and reassessment.	None per control; supports meta-gates CG-11, CG-12 (evaluated across all controls)	AIDCF-018-EVA

The authoritative control-to-gate mapping is per control in the AIDCF-007A registry (`gateMappings`, roles CRITICAL or SUPPORTING).

Programme playbooks

Every playbook follows the common sequence: (1) define decision and intended users; (2) define capability, outcomes, scope, operating states and profile; (3) select Assurance Level, gates and evidence depth; (4) appoint provider and team and assess competence and independence; (5) approve evidence, methods, sampling, safety and review plan; (6) execute AIDCF-009, preserving UNKNOWN and conflict; (7) apply AIDCF-010; (8) complete technical and independent review; (9) issue the AIDCF-012 statement without certification language; (10) activate actions, triggers and reassessment. The distinctive elements of each playbook are:

Playbook	Trigger / decision	Level	Distinctive steps	Statement
Readiness	Preparing for deployment or deeper assurance.	AL1	Evidence-availability survey per control; gap roadmap; no decision state issued.	Readiness report (R1/R2)
Design assurance	Pre-build or major design decision.	AL2	Design-basis confirmation with capability owner; independent design review (E5) for gate-critical systems; DESIGN claims only.	AS per model
Deployment assurance	Commissioning, handover or go-live.	AL3–AL5	Witness integrated systems tests; reconcile as-built to design; capture commissioning evidence as E4 tied to the implemented configuration.	AS per model
Operational assurance	Reliance on current operation.	AL4	Define representative period and states; sample occurrences; review incidents and exceptions in period.	AS per model
Resilience assurance	Reliance on containment and recovery.	AL5	Select cross-domain scenarios; authorise integrated exercises; measure end-to-end outcome recovery.	AS per model
Major change	Material change to architecture, capacity, provider or control plane.	Affected claims	Change-impact mapping to controls and gates; delta reassessment; supersede prior decision.	AS per model; AS-08 where superseded
Incident-triggered	Incident affecting relied-on claims.	Affected claims	Set affected decisions SUSPENDED where material; preserve incident evidence; reassess affected gates.	AS-06, then AS per model or AS-07
Second-party	Customer, investor or contracting-party decision.	As chartered	Disclose commissioner and access limits; agree evidence rights in advance.	AS-03
Independent-provider	Third-party reliance.	As chartered	Provider conflict check, engagement terms, provider quality review.	AS-04

Playbook	Trigger / decision	Level	Distinctive steps	Statement
Continuing assurance	Ongoing reliance on designated claims.	AL6	Source register; refresh cadence; trigger monitoring; human review of material status changes.	AS-05

Machine-readable publication package

Tools implement declared workflow and never hidden authority.

Artifact	Purpose
aidcf-apf-config.json	Programme configuration.
programme-charter.schema.json	Decision, subject, users, model and authority.
programme-profile.schema.json	Level, type, controls, gates and evidence.
provider-role.schema.json	Competence and independence.
programme-plan.schema.json	Methods, safety and reviews.
validity-trigger.schema.json	Monitoring and reassessment.
quality-review.schema.json	Review, appeal and correction.
programme-audit.schema.json	Internal audit, management review and corrective action.
conformance-tests	Non-certification, safety and lineage fixtures.

Assurance statements use the AIDCF-012 assurance-statement schema. Ontology and validation shapes are published under AIDCF-014 and AIDCF-016.

AITG and graph mappings

Programme records are native AIDCF objects using AIDCF-014 classes and relationships.

Programme record	AIDCF-014 class	Relationship (AIDCF-014 §9)
Programme	AssuranceProgram	GOVERNED_BY (Assessment GOVERNED_BY AssuranceProgram)
Charter, profile	Properties of AssuranceProgram	—
Provider, roles	Properties of Assessment and ReviewRecord	REVIEWED_BY, APPROVED_BY
Capability	CapabilityInstance	ASSESSED_BY (CapabilityInstance ASSESSED_BY Assessment)
Evidence	EvidencePackage	SUPPORTS, CHALLENGES, QUALIFIES
Gate	GateResult	CONSTRAINS (GateResult CONSTRAINS AssuranceDecision)
Decision	AssuranceDecision	APPROVED_BY
Statement	AssuranceStatement	REPORTED_IN (AssuranceDecision REPORTED_IN AssuranceStatement)
Action	Action	REQUIRES_ACTION, CLOSED_BY
Trigger	ReassessmentTrigger	TRIGGERS_REASSESSMENT

Programme record	AIDCF-014 class	Relationship (AIDCF-014 §9)
Supersession	—	SUPERSEDES

Previous non-canonical relationships ASSIGNED_TO, ASSURES, EXECUTES, ISSUED_BY, REPORTS, REMEDIATES and REQUIRES_REVIEW are replaced as shown.

Templates

Assurance statements use AIDCF-012 templates AS-01 to AS-05; this framework provides programme templates only.

Template — Programme Charter

Field	Entry
programmeId	Stable programme identifier.
decisionQuestion	Decision the programme supports.
intendedUsers	Named users and permitted reliance.
capability	Capability Instances in scope.
outcomes	Service Outcomes and tolerances.
model	Programme model (Part III).
type	Assessment type (Part V).
level	Assurance Level AL0–AL6.
statementTemplate	AIDCF-012 template (AS-01–AS-05).
authority	Sponsor and decision authority.
managementSystem	Integration with ISO/IEC 42001 or ISO/IEC 27001 systems (XXI.7).
constraints	Access, safety, legal and confidentiality constraints.
approvals	Charter approvals.

Template — Programme Profile

Field	Entry
scope	Capability Instances and boundary.
states	Operating states in scope.
controls	Applicable controls and claim types.
gates	Applicable gates.
evidenceDepth	Profile tiers and sufficiency floors.
methods	AIDCF-009 methods and Part B elements adopted.
outputs	AIDCF-012 report classes.
validity	Validity period and triggers.

Template — Provider Record

Field	Entry
provider	Organisation.
roles	Roles assigned.
competence	Competence evidence (AC levels where adopted).
conflicts	Declared conflicts.
safeguards	Independence safeguards.
responsibilities	Responsibility split with management.
authority	Professional and contractual authority.

Template — Programme Plan

Field	Entry
workstreams	Domain workstreams and leads.
evidence	Evidence requests and access.
interviews	Interview plan.
inspections	Inspection plan.
samples	Sampling plans.
tests	Test plans and authorisations.
safety	Rules of engagement.
reviews	Technical and independent reviews.
stageGates	PG-0 to PG-9 dates and approvers.

Template — Continuing Assurance

Field	Entry
claims	Designated monitored claims.
sources	Source register and owners.
thresholds	Trigger thresholds.
refresh	Refresh cadence.
blindSpots	Uncovered states and source outages.
triggers	Reassessment Triggers.
review	Human review arrangements.
decisionState	Current decision state and lifecycle state.
snapshot	Snapshot reference.

Template — Quality Review

Field	Entry
reviewId	Stable identifier.
reviewType	Hot review, cold review or consultation.
scope	Decisions and packages reviewed.
samples	Items sampled.
technicalApprovals	Approvals verified.
challenges	Challenges raised.
dispositions	Resolution of challenges.
appeals	Appeals received and outcome.
corrections	Corrections or supersessions issued.
release	Release decision.

Template — Programme Audit and Management Review

Field	Entry
auditId	Stable identifier.
auditor	Auditor and independence basis.
auditScope	Topics and assessments sampled (XXI.3).
nonconformities	Programme nonconformities and classification.
correctiveActions	Actions, owners, due dates and effectiveness review.
managementReviewRef	Management review at which results were considered.
decisions	Management-review decisions and improvement-register entries.

Annex A — Conformance validation and requirement mapping

The following requirements are validation rules applied to every programme.

APF-REQ-019 The programme charter shall state the decision question, intended users, Capability Instances and Service Outcomes.

APF-REQ-020 The programme model, assessment type and Assurance Level shall be approved at PG-1 or PG-2.

APF-REQ-021 Scope, operating states, dependencies and exclusions shall be visible in the programme profile.

APF-REQ-022 Applicable controls, claim types and gates shall be defined in the programme profile.

APF-REQ-023 Evidence depth shall match the claim types concluded (Part IV).

APF-REQ-024 Competence and independence of every assessor and reviewer shall be assessed and recorded before PG-3.

APF-REQ-025 Management and assessor responsibilities shall be recorded separately.

APF-REQ-026 Safety and stop criteria shall be documented in the programme plan.

APF-REQ-027 UNKNOWN Records and conflicts shall remain visible in every programme output.

APF-REQ-028 Scores shall not override Gate Results.

APF-REQ-029 Tooling shall not approve results, Gate Results or decisions automatically.

APF-REQ-030 Corrections and supersessions shall preserve history.

APF-REQ-031 A public summary shall not be stronger than the full report.

v1.0 validation	v1.1 requirement
APF-VAL-001	APF-REQ-001
APF-VAL-002	APF-REQ-019
APF-VAL-003	APF-REQ-020
APF-VAL-004	APF-REQ-021
APF-VAL-005	APF-REQ-022
APF-VAL-006	APF-REQ-023
APF-VAL-007	APF-REQ-024
APF-VAL-008	APF-REQ-025
APF-VAL-009	APF-REQ-026
APF-VAL-010	APF-REQ-027
APF-VAL-011	APF-REQ-028
APF-VAL-012	APF-REQ-007
APF-VAL-013	APF-REQ-009
APF-VAL-014	APF-REQ-010
APF-VAL-015	APF-REQ-029
APF-VAL-016	APF-REQ-030
APF-VAL-017	APF-REQ-031

Other identifier changes: artifact ID AIDCF-APF-001 → AIDCF-011; the five "Statement Template" sections → AIDCF-012 AS-01–AS-05; the "Template — Assurance Statement" → AIDCF-012 AS templates; the AL0–AL6 profile sections → Part IV table; the fifteen domain programme profiles → "Domain programme coverage" table; the ten programme playbooks → "Programme playbooks" table; the "Review and release gates" table → Part XXII.

Final doctrine

AIDCF-011 enables disciplined, self-improving assurance programmes without presenting AIDCF as a certifying or accrediting body. The issuer remains responsible for competence, independence, professional obligations and the bounded statement issued. The assessed organisation remains responsible for the capability, risks, controls, actions and decisions.